

Impact High · Difficulty Medium · Misuse risk Low

THE MOVE

Disagree with the idea -> Stay curious -> No dismissal signals

START HERE

Before disagreeing, check your face and tone. Remove any dismissal — eye-roll, sigh, 'obviously', sarcasm. Then disagree with the position, not the person.

SAY THIS

Disagreement Openers	<i>"I see this differently — my view is..."</i>
Curiosity Phrases	<i>"Help me understand how you got there."</i>
Disagreeing Upward	<i>"Can I offer a different read before we lock this in?"</i>
Meeting Disagreement	<i>"I want to offer a counter-view so we pressure-test this properly."</i>
Heat Reducers	<i>"That came out harder than I intended. The disagreement stands; the edge does not."</i>

AVOID

- When the other person's position is genuinely harmful and requires sharp, unambiguous challenge — softness can imply tacit endorsement.
- In high-stakes negotiations where tactical firmness is operationally necessary.
- When you have already tried respectful disagreement repeatedly and the priority is clarity over tone.

REMEMBER

Contempt leaks through the channel you are not watching.